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WHAT IS A PROFESSION.

1. Profession is a type of job/occupation that needs special training, or skills, and knowledge that lead to competency, change in attitude, mastery necessary for some years of training indicated ~~it~~ which may special for the group e.g Teaching profession, medical profession, Accountancy profession. The person that has acquired the skills and other require attributes must expect some income or wages salary for that.
2. Profession is a paid occupation, especially one that involves prolonged training and a formal qualification.

WHAT IS PROFESSIONALISM

This is the competence or skill expected of a professional. It is also the skill, good judgement, and that is expected from a person who is trained to ~~be~~ do a job well. It requires sufficient training. The training equips individuals in the profession with attributes that make them effective and efficient in their jobs.

(2)

CHARACTERISTICS OF A PROFESSION

1. Specialised and systematic occupational knowledge, often presented by skills.
2. Acquisition of specialised knowledge and expertise through long period of advanced education, training.
3. Continuous in-service growth.
4. A long life vocation/career and permanent membership.
5. Profession of close-knit occupation with group consciousness.
6. Self autonomy and authority to control admissions, recruitment, training, qualifying exams, license, certification, standards of practice and retention of members.
7. Affirmative public recognition and respect of professional mandate or authority often backed up by laws.
8. Service oriented and in best interest of society for satisfying some specific needs.
9. Having professional code of conduct of its practitioners.
10. Demonstrating competence through passing some prescribed examinations usually organised by an approved body.

(3)

SOME DISTINCTIONS BETWEEN PROFESSIONALISM AND PROFESSIONALISM

PROFESSION	PROFESSIONALISM
1. It is an occupation or career which is pursued throughout one's life time	It is the high standard that is expected of individuals who are experts in a particular occupation or career.
2. It involves a collection of experts in a particular occupation	It is the exhibition of competence, skills, attitudes by professionals.
3. It creates a specialist function in an organisation.	Only competence plays a role in recruitment.
4. Sets values of relevance to its members	Adherence to the set values is utmost

ETHICS

Ethics are principles that guide a body of an organisation.

They are the moral principles that an individual uses in governing his or her behaviour. It is the personal criteria by which an individual distinguishes "right" from "wrong".

Anybody, group, organisation or society without ethics is bound to fail.

Therefore, there must be a disciplinary measures applicable to a professional who is guilty of professional misconduct. which are clearly stated in its ethic or code of conduct.

ADVANTAGES OF ETHICS

The following are the advantages of ethics -

1. It helps one to determine the propriety of his conduct in his profession.
2. It indicates the kind of professional posture one must maintain if he is to succeed.
3. It gives clients the feeling of confidence that the professional ~~is~~ truly wants to serve them well and places services above financial reward.
4. It gives clients assurance that standards of competence, independence and integrity shall remain the goal post of the professionals.

(5)

5. It enables member regulatory authorities their responsibility the professionals have and competence except employers, clients and public.

b. It makes sure that profession is protected and the profession is enhance. Public interest and credibility of the

DISADVANTAGES OF ETHICS

They are :-

- Loss of job/employment
- Loss of clients
- Lack of affluent but comfortable living
- Loss of wealth
- Loss of life
- Unpopularity.

VITTHAL ETHEICAL PRINCIPLES.

They are part of normal guidance that justifies or defends moral rules and/or moral judgments. They are part of accepted behaviours, expected by all to be exhibited by professionals anywhere they find themselves. There are good and bad ethical behaviours.

The good or positive behaviours or ethics

(6)

- are:
- 1 Initiative
 - 2 Tact and diplomacy
 - 3 Punctuality
 - 4 Enthusiasm
 - 5 Resilience under pressure
 - 6 Courtesy
 - 7 Interest in Business
 - 8 Desire to add to knowledge of Job.
 - 9 Adaptability, willingness to learn
 - 10 Personality and sense of humour.
 - 11 Appearance
 - 12 Anticipation of needs
 - 13 Loyalty
 - 14 Language Skills
 - 15 Commitment to the job.
 - 16 Organisation Skills
 - 17 Efficiency
 - 18 Reliability
 - 19 Responsibility
 - 20 Discretion
 - 21 Politeness
 - 22 Pleasant disposition
 - 23 Cheerfulness/smile
 - 24 Honesty/truthfulness
 - 25 Punctuality

The following are the negative work ethics:-

- 1 Sexual harassment
- 2 Abuse of Trust
- 3 Bad dressing for office, office party, lunch/dinner meetings with clients.
- 4 Personal hygiene
- 5 Cracking inappropriate Jokes

(7)

6. Showing Gratitude.
7. Do not pop your head over the top.
8. Not granting neighbour private time
9. Do not chime in conversation you hear over the wall.
10. Keep lunch in private place
11. Bad habits - e.g. drinking on the job, smoking, waste papers,
12. Shouting or being loud when laughing or talking etc.
13. Disrespect
14. Lateness
15. Absent from duty. ~~etc.~~
16. Unaccepted gift.
17. Music should not be loud. ~~etc.~~
18. Stealing

(8)

ETHICS AND MORALITY

Ethics is derived from the Greek word ETHOS meaning character or custom.

Ethics is defined as a system of morals or rules of behaviour. They are set of rules by individuals, groups, organisations, or professions to conform to. It moulds people's conducts in the right direction when properly conformed to. It may be rewarded, while violation of them is liable to punishment.

MORALITY

This is beliefs about what is right and what is wrong behaviour. The degree to which something is right and good, the moral goodness or badness of something. It is also a character or conduct considered as good or evil. This is behaviour of individual in the right direction.

This has to do with right or wrong behaviour and character, believing exactly according to what is considered by society to be wrong or acceptable.

(4)

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN ETHICS & MORALS

ETHICS

1. These are principles that control or influence a person's behaviour when he viewed as good or right, bad or wrong.
2. Being ethical is mostly restricted to group cohesiveness.
3. Being unethical may be occasional in some circumstances.
4. Ethics are of less character exhibition.
5. Ethics are written principles/standards that are expected to be observed by all that are concerned.
6. Ethics are based on legal rights or duties.
7. Ethics make one to understand the difference between right and wrong.

MORALS

- Values of conduct (behaviour) of an individual or group of people that are acceptable in a given society.
- Locality tends to be far more universal and fundamental.
- Being immoral is fundamental and permanent character flaws.
- Morals are of a much more greater character exhibition that may not be hidden.
- Morals are standards of behaviours that are acceptable - they are innate and may not be easily controlled.
- Morals are based on one's own sense of what is right or wrong, not necessarily a legal rights or duties.
- Person with high moral rarely acts immorally.

~~7~~ (10)

SIMILARITIES BETWEEN ETHICS

1. ETHICS deals with or is applied on human beings

~~2~~ ETHICS

2. ETHICS are directing at doing the right things as stipulated by profession or organisation

ETHICS & MORALS

Morals are concerned with behaviours of human beings

Moral is concerned with right behaviour be it in a profession or an organisation.

RELATIONSHIPS BETWEEN ETHICS

ETHICS AND MORALS

1. ETHICS are sometimes referred to as Morals

Moral is often referred to as ethics.

2. When ethics are applied on individual, they help mould such a persons behaviours

Morals help a person make ethical decisions

3. An organisation which abides by its ethics is unlikely to do unethical things

In organisation whose employees are morally sound will abide by their ethical code of conduct, thus no worker could want to be unethical in their dealings.

ETHICS

(8) (11)

Ethics are principles that guide a body or organisation. They are moral principles that an individual uses in governing his/her behaviour. The person's needs by which an individual distinguishes "right from wrong". Any society without ethics would be a chaotic and dangerous place in which to live.

Ethics makes room for efficiency and high productivity, an expert-knowledge and specialized skills acquired and maintained through rigorous corporate responsibility. Though, disciplinary measures applicable to a professional who is guilty of professional misconduct are clearly stated in its ethic or code of conduct.

As a professional, one is expected to display or exhibit competence, integrity and ethic. Competence is self-confidence in one's ability to professionalize the rule. Integrity is honesty and a strong commitment to ethical conduct by doing the right thing, acting with honesty and integrity even at the sacrifice of personal advantage.

PROFESSIONAL WORK ETHICS

Professional work ethics deals creating an ethically healthy environment for employees, where they can do their work conveniently and comfortably. Any profession that lacks integrity is likely to cause havoc in the organisation, other employees, clients and the public in general.

(12)

When working, it is expected that the prescribed steps of performing tests must be strictly adhered to. When working in laboratories, studios, the rules of these places must be duly followed.

LIST OF PROFESSIONAL BODIES.
The following are some of the professional bodies:-

1. MEDICAL PROFESSION

The global medical profession has maintained simple ethical standards for more than 4,000 years. Example is Hippocratic Oath. The majority of these historical documents focus on avoiding harm to patients. Though physicians and other medical professionals often face ethical challenges, many of them consider ethics to be a concept pertaining to the avoidance of harm.

Medical ethics is not about avoiding harm; rather, it is a set of norms, values and principles. These norms, values and principles are intended to govern medical ethical conduct.

2. ENGINEERING PROFESSION

Engineering is an important and learned profession. As members of this profession, engineers are expected to exhibit the highest standards of honesty and integrity. Engineering has a direct and vital impact

on the quality of life for all people.

Accordingly, the Service - provided by engineers require honesty, impartiality, fairness, and equity, and must be dedicated to the protection of the public health, safety, and welfare. Engineers must perform under a standard of professional behavior that requires adherence to the highest principles of ethical conduct.

3 The Secretarial Professional Ethics

The ethics of a Secretary and office of professionals are moral principles relating to the job that you will be bound by. These requirements are automatically taken on board when you accept any time. The body do the following to regulate ethical issues:-

a. Confidentiality: Always private and confidential you work for and its reveal sensitive information even if you are in a ~~situation~~ discussion where everyone is wondering what is happening and you know. Always be trusted.

b. Honesty

c. Loyalty

d. Reliable

- e. Responsible
 - f. Work Unsupervised
 - g. Be Co-operative
 - h. Flexibility
 - i. Multi-Skilling
- #### Accounting Ethics

The accounting ethics are based on the following principles:-

1. Principles of Continuity: This is used when stating financial information, One should assume that the business will not be interrupted.

2. Principle of Prudence: This principle aims at showing the reality "as it is". One should not try to make things look prettier than they are.

3. Principle of Non-compensation: One should show full detail of financial information and not seek to compensate a debt with an asset, revenue with an expense.

4. Principle of the Performance of Methods: This principle aims at allowing the coherence and comparison of the

financial information published by the company.

5. Principle of Sincerity: According to this principle, the accounting unit should reflect in good faith the reality of the company's financial status.
6. Principle of Consistency: This states that when a business has once fixed a method for the accounting treatment of an item, it will enter in exactly the same way all similar items that follow.
7. Principle of Regularity: This means that conformity to enforce rules and laws etc.